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‘I want to hear what he has to say, what he thinks we should be doing.’

TERRY EBERSOLE, *voter from Pennsylvania, speaking about Senator Bernie Sanders*

Sanders’ longtime message hitting home

Once divisive, now he’s unifying figure for Democrats

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

HARRISBURG, Pa. — Terry Ebersole and Betsy Delisle have never voted for Bernie Sanders. Nor would they call themselves dedicated fans of the left-wing Vermont senator; a more moderate Democrat like Pete Buttigieg is more to their liking.

But the retirees from Lancaster, Pa., still drove an hour each way to see Sanders speak last Friday, desperate to hear *someone* energize them with a vision of countering President Trump.

“I want a new game plan,” Ebersole said. “I

want to hear what he has to say, what he thinks we should be doing. I’m hoping he addresses that.”

Indeed, when his national “Fighting Oligarchy” rally tour stopped in Harrisburg, Sanders offered a great deal of criticism of Trump’s actions so far and also provided plenty of ideas for what Democrats should be doing to counter them. But his primary prescription to cure what ails the party hasn’t changed since his first bid for president in 2016.

“Our job right now,” he said, “is to demand and make certain that the agenda of the Demo-

SANDERS, Page A8



ANDRI TAMBUNAN/NEW YORK TIMES

A flag uniting Senator Bernie Sanders and Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez was seen at a rally last month.

Judges say Öztürk must be sent to Vt.

Reject White House claim federal courts do not have a role in deportation cases

By John R. Ellement
and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

Rümeysa Öztürk, the Tufts University graduate student arrested by federal immigration agents in March outside her Somerville apartment, must be returned to Vermont from Louisiana for a hearing over her detention, a federal appeals court ruled Wednesday.

The three-judge panel of the Second Circuit Court of Appeals, based in New York, rejected the Trump administration’s claim federal courts have no role in cases involving deportation.

The judges noted the 30-year-old Turkish PhD student specifically challenged her arrest and detention as unlawful, in what’s known as a habeas corpus petition and is a separate legal question from whether the government can revoke her student visa and deport her.

The federal judge in that detention case has scheduled a bail hearing for Friday in Vermont. But since the appeals panel gave the government one week to return Öztürk to Vermont from the detention facility in Louisiana, it’s unclear whether she will appear at the bail hearing remotely or

OZTURK, Page A9

Donors react as Harvard fights Trump

Some big givers step up and others stand down

By Hilary Burns and Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

For three weeks, Harvard University’s battle with the Trump administration has been a high-stakes standoff. Lines were crossed. Ultimatums issued. Angry tweets and spirited protests have rallied both sides.

To outsiders, it can look very black and white.

As with any conflagration between powerful parties, however, things are more gray behind the scenes. That’s especially true of the conversations between Harvard and some of its most prominent donors — key allies whose support, both political and financial, may be more important to the university now than ever before.

Harvard’s alumni span the political spectrum, and donations have surged since the university said it would stand up to the Trump administration, which has frozen \$2.2 billion in federal funding for what it says is egregious campus antisemitism.

But some major donors, including those with buildings named after them on the hallowed campus, have been frustrated with the university’s response, according to interviews with donors and administrators. They feel Harvard should make a

HARVARD, Page A9



VATICAN MEDIA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

PAPAL SELECTION UNDERWAY

An image from Vatican Media showed cardinals in the Sistine Chapel before the conclave began. Black smoke poured out of the chapel’s chimney on Wednesday, signaling that no pope had been elected as 133 cardinals opened the secretive, centuries-old ritual to choose a new leader of the Catholic Church. Cardinals said they expect a short conclave, though it will likely take at least a few rounds of voting. **A3.**

Former president Joe Biden stepped back into the public spotlight with a scathing condemnation of his successor and his handling of international affairs. **A2.**

The Federal Reserve kept its key interest rate unchanged, brushing off President Trump’s demands to lower borrowing costs. **D4.**

Massachusetts Senate leaders will “explore” legislation to ban cellphones in the state’s public schools, the chamber’s top Democrat said. **B1.**

Johnson backs off Medicaid cost cut plan

Shift highlights sharp split within Republican Party

By Catie Edmondson
and Margot Sanger-Katz
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Speaker Mike Johnson has dropped one of the most aggressive options the GOP was considering to cut Medicaid costs to help pay for President Trump’s domestic agenda, bowing to pressure from politically vulnerable Republicans and

underscoring the deep party divisions imperiling the plan.

Leaving his office Tuesday night after meeting with a group of more moderate members, Johnson told reporters that House Republicans had ruled out lowering the amount the federal government pays states to care for working-age adults who became eligible for the program through the Affordable Care Act’s Medicaid expansion.

Johnson also suggested he was leaning against another way of reducing spending on Medicaid, by changing the way the federal government

pays states — currently by providing a percentage of beneficiaries’ medical bills — to a flat fee per person.

“I think we’re ruling that out as well, but stay tuned,” the speaker said.

The retreat was an acknowledgment that many House Republicans viewed the ideas — both of which would create large state budget shortfalls — as politically toxic. It also underscored how difficult it will be for Johnson’s conference to find Medicaid cuts that hit the spending targets Republicans set for themselves

MEDICAID, Page A8

Brookline has lessons for Mass. on generational nicotine sales ban

But agreement elusive on health, retail impact

By Stella Tannenbaum
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Elias Audy is an unlikely proponent of a statewide ban on nicotine sales for young adults.

The gas station owner joined other Brookline tobacco retailers in suing to stop such a measure there, after the town in 2020 became the first in the nation to pass a lifetime ban on selling tobacco products to anyone born since the start of 2000.

Audy says cigarette sales at his store, Village Mobil, have been nearly halved and gas sales have fallen about 10 percent as drivers have gone elsewhere for their “one-stop shop.” Even so, he said he

supports the statewide version of the policy now being considered by the Massachusetts Legislature.

“This way, you’re getting everyone on the same level playing field,” he said.

Massachusetts, which has long been at the forefront of tobacco restrictions nationally, is debating a statewide generational ban on tobacco sales, which could have potentially dramatic implications for both public health and businesses.

Since the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court dismissed the tobacco sellers’ lawsuit in March 2024, upholding Brookline’s policy, over a dozen other cities and towns have adopted similar bans. Now, the Legislature is considering a bill prohibiting anyone born on or after Jan. 1, 2006 — who would be around 19 or younger today — from buying such prod-

NICOTINE, Page A12

ANOTHER CELTICS SHOCKER



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Two days after blowing a 20-point lead in the third quarter and dropping Game 1 in stunning fashion, the Celtics did it again Wednesday night at TD Garden, falling 91-90 to the Knicks. Jayson Tatum had a chance in the final seconds, but couldn’t get a shot off. **C1.**



Space in the cloud

Thursday: Clouds and sun. High: 67-72. Low: 46-51.
Friday: Breezy, some rain. High: 48-53. Low: 46-51.
Sunrise: 5:30 Sunset: 7:52
Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C10-11.**

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